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GIRLS DIVISION II STATE CHAMPIONSHIP



MARVIN FONG / THE PLAIN DEALER

Hathaway Brown players, from left to right, Angela Groves, Alexis Dobbs, Julie Lozon and Kristen Holmes are comforted by assistant coaches Amber Gooden and Dwayne Morrow during their 45-26 loss against River View in the Division II state tournament.

Win green-lighted

Daugherty sisters, River View humble Hathaway Brown

BOB FORTUNA
Plain Dealer Reporter

COLUMBUS — How appropriate is it that on St. Patrick's Day, a couple of HATHAWAY BROWN 45 kids named Daugherty

helped Warsaw River View win a state championship. Senior Kristin Daugherty and her sophomore sister, Kari, wreaked havoc on Hathaway Brown from the opening tip in a 45-26 Division II championship game victory Saturday afternoon at Value City Arena.

The win handed the Bears (26-1) their second consecutive state title and fourth overall in five Final Four appearances. Still, they felt they had something to prove because of their No. 2 ranking in the final state poll

"To be honest, that kind of ticked us off a little bit because we thought we deserved the No. 1 ranking," said River View coach Caroline Daugherty, also Kristin and Kari's mom.

"I think when you're defending champions, somebody's going to knock you off. We lost to a quality team in [Columbus] Africentric and we had the same amount of losses as [top-ranked Levittown] Indian Lake.

"But you can't see all the teams in the state and we're just excited to be here and to be celebrating."

Hathaway Brown (22-5), unranked and making its state tournament debut, caught the wrath of the Bears' frustration early.

River View scored nine unanswered points in taking a 12-3



MARVIN FONG / THE PLAIN DEALER

Alexis Dobbs goes to the floor against River View's Kristin Daugherty in the second quarter.

Girls Game Balls

Vote for the top girls basketball performer on cleveland.com/tlr. Voting is open until noon Tuesday. See who won Thursday in The Locker Room.

The contenders:

Jantel Lavender and Candace Flynn, Cleveland Central Catholic The Division III All-Ohio tournament team players helped the Ironmen seize their first state title, a 51-45 triumph over Delphos St. John, Lavender, Ohio's Ms. Basketball, scored 23 points (13 in the first half), and had nine rebounds and six blocked shots. Flynn, a second-team all Ohioan, delivered 11 points, five assists, two steals and a third-quarter 3-pointer to give the Ironmen the lead. Lavender finished the tournament with 37 points, 23 rebounds and 11 blocked shots; Flynn ended up with 21 points, 11 assists and six steals.

lead at the end of the first quarter as Co-Tournament Most Valuable Player Kari Daugherty scored six of her 16 points during that run, all of which came in the paint. She also finished with

seven rebounds.

The Bears led, 21-8, at intermission for two reasons. They shot 42.9 percent (21 of 49) while the Blazers made just three of 13 attempts from the field.

"I thought we were pretty focused when we came out and I thought we played defensively pretty well in the first half," Blazers coach Paul Barlow said. "We just didn't knock down any shots and that put us in a hole we really couldn't get out of."

Kari Daugherty carried River View on her shoulders in the first half with 11 points and six rebounds, before Kristin Daugherty took over after intermission.

Kristin, a 6-1 senior and University of Dayton recruit, scored 14 of her 19 points and collected half of her eight rebounds in the final 16 minutes to share MVP honors with her sister. Both were game highs.

"That early run was big," said Caroline Daugherty, a player on River View's 1982 Class AA state title team that was coached by her dad, Dave Mast. "We wanted to jump on them right away and not let them feel like they were going to be in the ballgame."

Freshman Mylan Woods scored seven of the Blazers' eight first-half points and finished with nine points and six rebounds, both team highs. Junior Angela Groves collected seven points and four rebounds.

"I think there was an intimidation factor going into the game since we knew they had already won three state titles," said Blazers senior guard Julie Lozon. "We were ready for it, we just didn't capitalize."

Obviously, the luck of the Irish wasn't with the Blazers.

To reach this Plain Dealer reporter: bfortuna@plaind.com, 216-999-4665

GIRLS STATE NOTEBOOK

School's nickname has unusual origin

BOB FORTUNA
AND TIM ROGERS
Plain Dealer Reporters

COLUMBUS — Hathaway Brown obtained its unusual nickname of the Blazers following a contest by alumnae about 25 years ago, Athletic Director Laurette Payette said.

And, no, they are not named after the style of jacket students once wore.

"The older alums might have thought that, but the younger ones were thinking along the lines of being trailblazers," Payette said.

The 130-year-old all-girls school, which began as an all-boys church/school, did not have a nickname until girls sports started becoming more prevalent in the late 1970s.

Been there: Former St. Vincent-St. Mary and University of Akron star Romeo Travis was part of the Central Catholic crowd. His cousin is Central senior Angela Bryant, who had four points, four rebounds and a steal in the Ironmen's 51-45 victory over Delphos St. John's in the Division III title game.

Count us in: A crowd of 4,624 watched the Division III game and 4,936 watched the Division II game. The Division IV game attracted 3,734 — despite one of the participants being from the area in Columbus Africentric — and the Division I game drew 3,576.

Not enough: Hathaway Brown's 26 points were the fewest ever scored in a Division II state championship game, and the combined 71 by the Blazers and Warsaw River View tied the record for the fewest by two teams in a Division II title game. The old record by one team was shared by Lake Catholic — in a 48-29 loss to River View in 2006 — and New Lexington — in a 54-29 loss to Millersburg West Holmes in 1985.

Elite stuff: River View joined

Regina among others as one of 11 schools in Ohio to win back-to-back state championships.

Not quite: By beating Delphos St. John's, Central Catholic prevented the Blue Jays from winning the school's sixth state title and tying Pickerington for the most state championships in state history.

Dr.'s orders: Central Catholic Athletic Director Marty Hyland kept with a pregame ritual he began earlier this season — he drank a can of Dr. Pepper before the Division III state title game.

"It was way too early this morning to be drinking this stuff," Hyland said prior to Saturday's 10:45 a.m. tipoff. "But I'm kind of superstitious, so I drank it anyway."

Absent, but not forgotten: River View freshman reserve Cortnie Kelso missed the Division II state title game after undergoing an emergency appendectomy earlier in the day at Columbus Children's Hospital.

"Cortnie was complaining of a pain in her side [Friday night] but didn't want to tell anyone because she wanted to play," said Bears coach Caroline Daugherty. "She was taken to the hospital, tests were run and she had surgery [Saturday] morning."

"I feel so bad for her, but she was with us in spirit and she'll get a ring just like everybody else."

Wrist reminder: Hathaway Brown freshman Mylan Woods wears tape around her left wrist with the words, "Hips and Wrists" written on it.

"[The tape] reminds me to sink my hips and wrinkle my wrists when I'm at the foul line," Woods said.

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GIRLS DIVISION IV STATE FINAL Africentric takes 1st title

MARIE WILLIAMS
Associated Press

COLUMBUS — Columbus Africentric would not allow a comeback this time.

Ashar Harris scored 11 points, and Africentric set a new record for fewest points allowed in a Division IV girls basketball championship game by beating New Knoxville, 44-27. Saturday to claim its first state title.

Unlike the semifinals, when the Nubians (27-1) gave up a 16-point lead and needed a 3-pointer with just under two seconds left from Chynna Boze-

man to beat Ottoville, top-ranked Africentric opened the championship game with an 11-0 run and then widened the lead to 20 with an 11-1 run to end the third quarter.

Harris said the Nubians learned from their semifinal game Friday.

"We didn't come out with as much energy in the second half," she said.

The 27 points scored by the Rangers (22-4) set a record for fewest points by one team, and the 71 points scored by both teams also set a record for fewest points in a Division IV championship game.

STATE INDOOR TRACK

Tigers' win stuns Glenville

BOB MIGRA
Plain Dealer Reporter

Some high school sports fans might yawn about winning a team championship in the state indoor track meet, a non-sanctioned event overseen by the Ohio Association of Track and Cross Country Coaches. Not the athletes, coaches and fans from Cleveland Heights.

"I don't think anybody will ever forget this," Cleveland Heights coach Claude Holland said, after the Tigers ended Glenville's two-year reign in the third annual Division I state meet at the University of Akron. "It's a big day. It's a coach's dream."

The scene after the Tigers clinched the team title with a victory in the 4x400 relay could not have been much more jubilant if it took place in June at the outdoor state meet at Jesse Owens Memorial Stadium. The Tigers probably wouldn't mind giving it a try, though.

"It's crazy," Cleveland Heights junior Jared Hall said. "This is awesome. I can't wait until June."

Hall won the 800 meters, in 1:56.53, and ran on the Tigers' first-place 4x800 and 4x400 relays. Cleveland Heights also won the 4x200, for a sweep of the relays. They set meet and fieldhouse records in each event.

Kyle Jefferson won the 200 meters (21.86) and 400 meters (48.12) to lead Glenville to a third-place team

finish.

Collinwood won its third consecutive girls Division I championship. Buchtel, led by freshman Kachay Hullum, won the girls Division II/III team title.

The Railroaders did not have an individual champion, but ran away with victories in the 4x200 and 4x400 relays.

Beaumont's Aaron Payne won the 60 meters (7.61) and the 200 meters (24.27) in a tremendous duel with Euclid's Jessica Beard, the 400-meter champion (55.75). Other champions included Beaumont's Emily Infeld in the 1,600 meters (5:09.08) and Warrensville Heights' Kaylon Eppinger in the 60-meter hurdles (8.95).

Buchtel's Hullum had four firsts, winning the 60 meters (7.71), the 200 meters (25.34) and the 400 meters (56.02). She also anchored the winning 4x400 relay. Chelsea James won the long jump (17-14) for Buchtel's other championship.

Ava Haynes led Beachwood to a runner-up girls finish with a state championship in the 60-meter hurdles, in 9.04. Crestwood's Cassandra Schenck (1,600 and 3,200) and Villa Angela-St. Joseph's Justin Eddie (60 meters and long jump) both were double winners.

To reach this Plain Dealer reporter: bmigra@plaind.com, 1-800-767-2821

HIGH SCHOOL SCOREBOARD

BOYS BASKETBALL

Regional finals

Division I

at University of Akron

Cleveland 17 21 18-43

Flintstone 9 13 12 18-58

Glenn Dale 17 21 18-43

St. Edward 15 18 16-56

Flintstone 9 13 12 18-58

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